
B E U B Y B A N K I S L A M × U M P S A

HACKATHON X FINTECH FORWARD 2026

Case Study & Challenge Tracks

T H E M E

"Future of Money: Reimagine Finance with AI"

2 Tracks • Unlimited Possibilities

Use AI. Solve real problems. Have fun.

Prepared by Be U by Bank Islam
Digital Transformation, Group Digital, Bank Islam

BEFORE YOU START

This hackathon is about one thing: solving real problems that affect real people.

We do not care about fancy words. We do not care if you use the newest or trendiest tool out there. We care about whether you understood a problem well enough to build something that actually helps someone.

Here is what we want you to know before you jump in:

Solve a Problem Someone Actually Has

Start with a person. Who are they? What makes their life difficult? What do they wish existed? Talk to people if you can. Your classmates, your family, a makcik selling nasi lemak, a student who is bad with money. The best ideas come from really understanding someone, not from guessing.

Have Fun. That Is Not Optional.

This is a hackathon, not an exam. Eat the pizza. Make friends on other teams. Stay up late arguing about silly things. Build something you are proud to show off, even if it is a bit rough. We would rather see a big idea that half-works than a boring idea that is perfectly polished.

PRO TIP

The winning teams almost always have one thing in common. They picked a problem they personally cared about.

TRACK 1: REIMAGINE MONEY

Fintech • Payments • Savings • Fraud Detection • Financial Inclusion

“How will you reimagine banking?”

Build something that changes how people earn, save, spend, or protect their money.

Why This Matters

Let us be honest. A lot of young Malaysians are not great with money. Not because they are lazy or careless, but because nobody really taught them. Students graduate knowing how to pass exams, but not how to save, budget, or plan ahead.

At the same time, scams are getting worse. Your parents get fake messages from "banks" every week. Small businesses at the pasar malam still mostly use cash because going digital feels complicated. And for a Muslim-majority country, finding simple Shariah-compliant financial tools should not be this hard.

We are not asking you to build another banking app. We are asking you to look at a real problem someone has with money and fix it.

Problem Spaces

Pick one and go deep. Or define your own, as long as it is a real problem with a real person behind it.

Catching the Bad Guys: Fraud and Scam Detection

Scams are everywhere. Fake SMS from "banks". Dodgy WhatsApp investment groups. Phishing links that look real. People lose actual money to this every single day. The tools to stop it exist, but most regular people do not have access to them.

What could you build?

- A tool that spots suspicious transactions before money leaves someone's account, not after.
- A scam checker that helps normal people figure out if a message, link, or phone call is real or fake.
- A system that learns from scam reports and gets smarter over time. Like community-powered fraud intelligence.
- A real-time alert for merchants when something looks off, like a sudden burst of weird transactions from one card.

PRO TIP

Think about it: your mum gets a WhatsApp message saying her bank account will be frozen. She panics. What tool would actually help her in that moment?

Money Habits: Saving, Spending, and Knowing Better

Financial literacy content exists. But let us be real, most of it is boring and nobody reads it. The question is not "how do we teach people about money" but "how do we make good money habits feel easy and natural?"

- Can you build something that makes saving money fun? Something students actually want to open every day?
- What if AI could look at your spending and give you a friendly heads-up before you run out of money mid-month?
- How would you design a "financial health check" that is as simple to understand as a fitness tracker?

Payments That Work for Everyone

Malaysia has DuitNow, e-wallets, QR codes. The infrastructure is there. But try paying for nasi lemak with your phone at a small stall. Or try splitting a group dinner bill without it becoming a whole drama.

- How do you make going cashless super simple for a small merchant who does not have a tech team?
- Can you finally fix group payments? Splitting bills, collecting money for trips, managing shared expenses without the awkwardness?
- What does a payment experience look like for someone who is not comfortable with technology?

Islamic Digital Finance

Malaysia leads the world in Islamic finance. But most of that innovation happens at the big institutional level. For a regular person, especially a young person, finding a simple Shariah-compliant savings product or understanding takaful is harder than it should be.

- How do you make Shariah-compliant products like savings, takaful, or ethical investing feel relevant and easy for young Malaysians?
- Can AI help with Islamic financial planning? Think zakat calculation, halal investment screening, or personalised Shariah-compliant advice.
- What would a community waqf or sadaqah platform look like if it was designed for today's generation?

What Judges Want to See

1. A problem that is real and specific. You can describe the person who has this problem.
2. A solution that fits how people actually behave, not how you wish they would.
3. Smart use of AI where it actually makes things better, not just added for the sake of it.
4. A working demo. Show us, do not just tell us.

TRACK 2: AI FOR GOOD

Artificial Intelligence • Chatbots • Conversational AI • Machine Learning • Social Impact

“What problem can you solve with AI that genuinely helps people?”

Not AI for the sake of AI. AI because it is the right tool for a real job.

Why This Matters

AI is probably the most powerful tool you will learn to use in your career. Right now, a lot of that power goes toward selling ads and recommending videos. That is fine, but there are much harder and more important problems out there. Healthcare in rural areas. Education gaps. Public services that are slow and confusing.

This track is for teams who want to use AI to fix something that actually matters. Pick any domain you want. We care that you found a real problem, understood the people affected, and built something useful.

Problem Spaces

This track is wide open on purpose. You pick the domain. Here are areas where AI can make a real difference, but do not let this list limit you.

Chatbots That Actually Help

Let us be honest. Most chatbots are terrible. You have definitely typed "TALK TO A HUMAN" into a customer service bot before. But the technology has gotten much better. The problem is most chatbots have not caught up.

What if a chatbot could actually solve your problem instead of sending you in circles?

- A university assistant that helps students with course registration, financial aid, hostel bookings, and all those admin things that always take too long.
- A government services bot that understands Bahasa Malaysia, English, and local dialects, and actually answers your question instead of redirecting you.
- An AI assistant for small business owners that handles customer questions, takes orders, or manages bookings through WhatsApp.
- A mental health support companion that knows when to listen, when to help, and when to suggest talking to a professional. Built for how Malaysian students actually talk and feel.

PRO TIP

The bar for chatbots is low because most of them are bad. If you build one that people actually want to use, you will stand out immediately.

Healthcare and Wellness

Getting good health info in Malaysia can be surprisingly hard. Clinic queues are long. Mental health still carries stigma. Rural areas have limited access to specialists.

- Early screening tools using data people already have, like phone sensors, self-reported symptoms, or wearable devices.
- A triage helper that tells you whether you should see a doctor now or if it can wait. Saves time for patients and clinics.
- Health information tools for people with low literacy or poor internet connection.

Education and Learning

Every student learns differently, but the system treats everyone the same. AI can change that if built with care.

- A tutor that adapts to how fast or slow each student learns, and figures out exactly where they are stuck.
- A tool for teachers to spot students who are falling behind early, before it becomes a bigger problem.
- Study tools that actually understand Malaysian curriculum and work in BM, not just English.

Environment and Sustainability

Climate problems are global, but many of the best solutions are local and specific.

- Flood prediction or early warning systems using public data and simple sensors.
- AI tools that help small farmers with crop health, pest problems, or market prices.
- Tools that encourage people or businesses to reduce waste through better habits, not guilt.

Accessibility and Inclusion

Technology should work for everyone. It often does not.

- Tools that make digital services usable for people with disabilities, low tech skills, or bad internet.
- Language technology for Malaysian languages and dialects that the big tech companies ignore.
- Systems that catch and reduce bias in everyday things like hiring, lending, or public services.

What Judges Want to See

1. A real problem you can describe clearly. Who has this problem? Why does it matter?
2. Responsible AI use. You can explain how your model works, what data it needs, and where it might go wrong.
3. Technical depth. We will ask how it works under the hood. "We used an API" is not enough.
4. Evidence this could actually help people if you kept building it after the hackathon.

A NOTE ON USING AI

We will say it again: we want you to use AI. This is 2026. Not using AI in a hackathon is like not using Google in a research project.

What We Encourage

- Use AI coding assistants to write and debug code faster.
- Build AI models into your solution. Language models, vision, classification, whatever fits your problem.
- Use AI to brainstorm ideas, research, generate test data, or prototype designs.
- Build products where AI is the core of the whole thing, not just a helper on the side.

What We Need From You

- List the AI tools you used in your repository README under "AI Tools Used."
- Be ready to explain your code and architecture when judges ask. If you cannot walk someone through your own project, that is a red flag.
- Know the limits of whatever AI you use. "It uses GPT" is not an answer. Tell us what it does, why you chose it, and where it might fail.

What Is Not OK

- Submitting AI-generated code that you do not understand and cannot change.
- Copying another team's AI-generated work.
- Using AI to generate your entire pitch with no real thinking behind it.

PRO TIP

The best teams do not just generate code with AI. They think with it. Use it to explore ideas, test assumptions, and move faster. Then make it yours.

WHO WE ARE

Be U is Malaysia's first Islamic digital bank, built from scratch by Bank Islam. We are not a traditional bank that added an app. We are a digital-first team that designed everything around making banking simple, accessible, and Shariah-compliant from day one.

Behind Be U is a diverse team of people who genuinely care about building good products. Engineers who write and own their code. Designers who obsess over making things easy to use. Product people who talk to real customers every week. Business leads who think about sustainability and growth. Compliance and Shariah experts who make sure everything we do is right. And a leadership team that believes in giving people room to try new things and learn fast.

We are part of Bank Islam's Digital Transformation family, working alongside teams across Group Digital and the wider bank. Together, we serve millions of customers across Malaysia. But our culture still feels like a startup: move fast, own your work, fix things when they break, and always keep the customer at the centre.

We are at this hackathon because we believe great ideas can come from anywhere. Some of the best thinking we have seen did not come from boardrooms or consultants. It came from students who cared about a problem and were brave enough to build a solution.

If your project shows real promise, we are happy to talk about what comes next. Mentorship, internships, or even building it together. We mean that.

Now go build something great.